



"We don't chase trends, we chase teachings"

INDIA'S BIGGEST PODCAST HOST TALKS HUMBLE BEGINNINGS, 100 REJECTIONS A WEEK, AND THE 4.93% THAT KEEPS HIM GOING

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The first 50 episodes of what became *Figuring Out* were recorded on a phone's voice memo app by Shamani himself sitting under a blanket. Almost nobody listened – Raj Shamani reckons half the listeners were him, replaying his own episodes. Fast forward five years, and now the show runs on a team of about 100, with its own research department and a man whose job title is head of errors and experiments. Shamani has since put Emmanuel Macron, Sunita Williams, Bill Gates and Vijay Mallya in the chair, on his way to becoming a household name.

In this exclusive interview, Shamani recounts his journey that transfers to anyone starting out, including the systems and principles at play, the rejection maths, and the discipline that separates a podcast from a hobby.

Take us back to the earliest version of the show?

Raj: The first 50 episodes were just me. I was the team, I was the format, I was everything. First the name of the show was *Voices with Raj*, then it became *Mind Your Own Business*, then it became *That Useless Kid*. Then I was like, no name is working out. Let me do one thing, let's call it *Figuring Out* – I'm figuring out how to actually be consistent also. I remember, the first 50 or 53 episodes total, I had about 50 to 53 audio listeners. I'm